

词汇: *music and health* 音乐与健康

- 1 From singing at concerts to singing 'Happy birthday'. Around the world, humans have been singing **in unison** for millennia. Some anthropologists even think our ancestors may have sung before they could speak. "**Lullabies** are sung to children, and then songs are sung at funerals", says Alex Street, from the Cambridge Institute for Music Therapy Research, who thinks that our positive response to music is no accident. Music is not only enjoyable, but beneficial for our health.
- 2 There is growing evidence that singing can energise us, improve **immune** function and increase feelings of happiness, according to 'A Review of the Physiological Effects and Mechanisms of Singing', published in 2018. It's thought that the repeated and controlled breathing that singing requires releases **endorphins**, which are chemicals released by the brain associated with pleasure and wellbeing. It may even provide a physical workout comparable to a **brisk** walk. And singing as part of a group or **choir** may have additional effects. Researchers in 'The ice-breaker effect: singing mediates fast social bonding' found that singing together accelerated faster **social cohesion** among strangers.
- 3 Some studies have also found that regular musical activity can help to delay the **onset** of various **neurological** conditions such as Parkinson's disease and **dementia**. And it's not too late for those already living with such conditions. Cathy McGlynn is a music therapist based in Ireland who leads a choir of people with Parkinson's. The disease can lead to **respiratory** and vocal problems, both of which are benefited by singing practice. For those suffering with dementia, singing can enhance the type of memory which helps us recall names and specific personal experiences, according to a literature review on singing and **cognitive** health called 'A Song for the Mind'. Music therapist Grace Meadows watched as a woman with dementia got up out of her chair and started dancing at a musical performance. "It was the first time the carers had ever seen her move, unaided."
- 4 Music may not be a medicine in the traditional sense, but one thing seems clear: humans are wired for connection, and music helps to create it. So, if you're sceptical about the power of music, it may be time to **change your tune**.

## 测验与练习

### 一、根据文章内容选出正确的段落。

Which paragraph contains the benefits of singing for age-related disorders?

### 二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Humans have been singing together for thousands of years.
  - a. True
  - b. False
  - c. Not given
2. Anthropologists are sure that our ancestors sung before they could speak.
  - a. True
  - b. False
  - c. Not given
3. In paragraph 2, what does the pronoun '**it**' refer to in the sentence: *It may even provide a physical workout...*?
  - a. music
  - b. singing
  - c. dancing
4. Singing together accelerated faster social cohesion among strangers because they enjoy listening to each other's voices.
  - a. True
  - b. False
  - c. Not given
5. What's another way of saying 'delay the onset' in paragraph 3?
  - a. postpone the development
  - b. reduce the risk
  - c. ignore the signs

### 三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Humans have sung **1)** \_\_\_\_\_ for thousands of years, from a gentle **2)** \_\_\_\_\_ to a powerful performance in a **3)** \_\_\_\_\_. Research suggests that singing may trigger the release of **4)** \_\_\_\_\_, helping to boost mood and wellbeing. Some studies even indicate that regular musical activity could delay the **5)** \_\_\_\_\_ of neurological conditions such as dementia.

|                |              |                        |
|----------------|--------------|------------------------|
| <b>lullaby</b> | <b>onset</b> | <b>social cohesion</b> |
| <b>brisk</b>   |              | <b>endorphins</b>      |
| <b>choir</b>   |              | <b>in unison</b>       |

(答案见词汇表后)

## 词汇表

|                          |           |
|--------------------------|-----------|
| <b>in unison</b>         | 齐声地，一致地   |
| <b>lullaby</b>           | 摇篮曲       |
| <b>immune</b>            | 免疫的       |
| <b>endorphin</b>         | 内啡肽       |
| <b>brisk</b>             | 轻快的       |
| <b>choir</b>             | 合唱团，合唱队   |
| <b>social cohesion</b>   | 社会凝聚力     |
| <b>onset</b>             | 发作，开始     |
| <b>neurological</b>      | 神经系统的     |
| <b>dementia</b>          | 痴呆        |
| <b>respiratory</b>       | 呼吸的，呼吸系统的 |
| <b>cognitive</b>         | 认知的       |
| <b>change one's tune</b> | 改变态度      |

## 答案

一、根据文章内容选出正确的段落。

**Paragraph 3.** Parkinson's disease and dementia are both typically age-related disorders.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a. True.** *Around the world, humans have been singing in unison for **millennia**.*
2. **b. False.** *Some anthropologists even **think** our ancestors **may have** sung before they could speak.*
3. **b.** 'It' refers back to the word 'singing' in the previous sentences.
4. **c. Not given.** The reason why social cohesion was accelerated is not mentioned in the text.
5. **a. postpone the development**

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Humans have sung **in unison** for centuries, from a gentle **lullaby** to a powerful performance in a **choir**. Research suggests that singing may strengthen the **immune** system and trigger the release of **endorphins**, helping to boost mood and wellbeing. Some studies even indicate that regular musical activity could delay the **onset** of conditions such as dementia.